Contact

elif@elifyurdakul.net

www.linkedin.com/in/elif-yurdakul-phd (LinkedIn)
elifyurdakul.net/ (Company)

Top Skills

Decision-Making
Change Management
Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Languages

English (Full Professional)

Certifications

Mindfulness Coaching
200 Hour Yoga Alliance Certified Yoga Teacher Training
TS EN ISO 9001 Quality Management Systems Internal Audit
Psoas & Core Awareness
International Trauma Studies Program

Publications

IMC: Integrated Marketing Communication, in Selcen Ozturkcan , Elif Yolbulan Okan (ed.) Marketing Management in Turkey (Marketing in Emerging Markets, Volume)

Elif Yurdakul

Closing the gap between AI adoption and human adaptability | Organizational Psychologist & Strategist, PhD
Berlin Metropolitan Area

Summary

I turn new technology into new ways of working.I understand how organizations decide, why people resist, and how tools actually get used. I build with AI, design the change, and stay with it until it becomes everyday practice.Strategy, psychology, and hands-on execution at once.If your organization is investing in AI and wants it to actually change how your people work, let’s talk.↳ Substack: elifyurdakul.substack.com↳ Website: elifyurdakul.net

Experience

Self-Update

Founder | Organizational Psychologist
November 2024 - Present (2 years)
Berlin, Germany

Helping organizations build the adaptive capacity required for AI-driven transformation.

Organizations rarely struggle because they lack strategy or technology. They struggle because their capacity to adapt cannot keep pace with the demands of change.

Through Self-Update, I work with boards, executive teams and operational leaders to strengthen the human capability behind transformation—how leaders make decisions under uncertainty, how teams adopt new ways of working, and how organizations sustain change beyond implementation.

My work focuses on four areas:

• Strategic adaptation for AI-driven transformation

• Executive decision quality under pressure

• AI adoption and workflow integration

• Resilient organizational performance during sustained change

Rather than implementing technology, I help organizations build the capability required to make transformation succeed.

Website: elifyurdakul.net

NADA Farkındalık Akademisi
Founder | Leadership & Wellbeing Programs
March 2020 - Present (6 years 8 months)
Istanbul, Türkiye

NADA designs evidence-informed wellbeing and resilience programs that help leaders, teams, and organizations perform sustainably under pressure.

Drawing on organizational psychology, mindfulness, breathwork, and stress regulation, we create practical learning experiences that strengthen leadership effectiveness, emotional resilience, and adaptive capacity.

Our work includes:

• Corporate wellbeing and resilience programs
• Leadership development workshops
• Stress management and emotional regulation
• Mindfulness and attention training
• Team wellbeing initiatives

Alongside our corporate work, NADA delivers pro bono workshops for educators, sports organizations, and community groups, making wellbeing education more accessible to those who support others.

IF Consultancy - iyi fikirler
Consultant
September 2018 - Present (8 years 2 months)
Istanbul, Türkiye

At IF Consultancy - iyi fikirler , I work as a business consultant specializing in corporate wellbeing and change management projects. I supported organizations in enhancing employee wellbeing, fostering resilience, and managing organizational change effectively. My role involved designing and delivering tailored programs that promoted mindfulness, stress management,

and innovation within corporate settings. Collaborating with diverse teams, I helped businesses navigate transformation while maintaining a positive and productive work environment.

Berlin School of Business & Innovation (BSBI)

Faculty

June 2024 - May 2026 (2 years)

Berlin

As a faculty member at BSBI, I have taught marketing, business, and entrepreneurship to a diverse student body from around the world. Working in this multicultural environment has enriched my teaching approach, emphasizing inclusivity, global perspectives, and real-world applications.
My focus has been on fostering a growth mindset in students, encouraging critical thinking, creativity, and innovation. By blending academic theory with practical insights, I aim to prepare future business leaders to thrive in dynamic, international markets.

Manetho

Co-Founder & Head of Growth

January 2021 - October 2024 (3 years 10 months)

Lviv, Ukraine

At Manetho (formerly Metta), I served as Head of Business Development, leading user growth, strategic partnerships, and blockchain integration. My role included driving fundraising efforts, collaborating with cross-functional teams, and developing innovative business models in the blockchain and NFT space. I played a key role in expanding the company’s presence, attracting new investors, and fostering collaborations with key industry players. This experience honed my skills in growth strategy, stakeholder management, and tech-driven business innovation, contributing significantly to the company’s success in a competitive market.

Istanbul Bilgi University

11 years 1 month

Asst. Prof. Dr. of Marketing and Organizational Psychology

July 2014 - June 2024 (10 years)

Istanbul, Istanbul, Türkiye

Providing onsite, fully online and blended lectures and consultancy to students.
Course experience design.
Creating course content.
Evaluation tools design.

Using online learning management system.
Courses: Global Marketing Strategies. Principles of Marketing. Consumer Behavior. Organizational Behavior. Business in Society. CRM. Management Communication. Theories of Organizational Psychology. Stress Management. Mind, Body and Resilience. Wellness and Happiness.

Strategic Planning Coordinator
July 2014 - October 2018 (4 years 4 months)
Istanbul, Turkey

For the first time in the university's history, we made an university wide strategic plan. In six domains, we created KPI's to reach the goals. I was the PM on the academic side of the customizing IBM tools project for universty's SP. IBM Turkey has got a regional product innovation award wit the project. In this for-year project I had following responsibilities:
• Reporting to the Rector to complementing and implementation of the university’s Strategic Plan
• Planning and executing SWOT analysis of the university; self-assessment survey design, execution and analysis, focus group meetings
• Determining corporate strategies, objectives and developing metrics
• Cascading down the corporate strategies to business units
• Communicating stakeholders to motivate them to be involved in the process
• Monitoring balanced scorecards and strategic KPIs for implementation and effectiveness of the strategies
• Leading in-house project team to develop a comprehensive strategic management tool with IBM
• Co-responsible for applying the EFQM Excellence Model
• Planning and execution of Course and Instructor Evaluation Survey involving the entire school within the frame of excellence in education

Graduate Programs, Corporate Relations and Business Development
June 2013 - June 2014 (1 year 1 month)
Istanbul, Istanbul, Türkiye

• Responsible for increasing Graduate Programs’ awareness and enrollment
• Developed corporate relationships with leading private and public cooperations to promote graduate programs and generate new leads to increase enrollment
• Responsible for increasing enrollment in the Online Banking and Finance Master Program
• Developed cooperation projects with leading private banks of Turkey to generate new leads to the the porgram

• Planned and executed a webinar project to promote the program, and reached leading banks' employees living in different cities
• Generated major increase in enrollment in the program
• Worked with International Students Department to follow up foreign candidates to complete the application process
• Developed a cooperation Project of producing online content between BILGI and Turkcell Academy.
• Managed sponsorship negotiations between BILGI and a leading Turkish bank to set up a stock market simulation lab in campus

Education

Marmara University

Doctor of Philosophy - PhD, Operations Management and Marketing · (2007 - 2013)

Istanbul Bilgi University

Master of Arts - MA, Industrial and Organizational Psychology · (2018 - 2020)

Marmara Üniversitesi

Master of Arts - MA, Advertising and Publicity · (2005 - 2007)